



Bond has always preferred British cars, and his preferred mode of travel is an Aston Martin—the DB5 in *Tomorrow Never Dies*

Gadget: Pen Grenade

Movie: *Golden Eye*

Perhaps the most clichéd of spy gadgets—no spy is complete without one! The pen looks like any other pen, but is actually a Class 4 grenade. You click the pen thrice (careful, fidgety people!) to activate the four-second detonation timer. If, within the four seconds, you click the pen thrice again, the bomb is deactivated. Here's one pen that's mightier than the sword for sure! Since Hollywood has done this gadget to death, not many people find it cool any more.

Plausible?

Well there is nothing against this really, except for how much of explosive you could store in such a tiny device—which leads to the question of whether any serious damage could be caused by such a small explosion.

Coolness Quotient: 1.5

Plausibility: 1.5



Left: Bond spying and clicking pictures with his digicam in *Golden Eye*; **Right:** controlling his BMW 750iL with his Ericsson phone

Gadget: Digital Camera

Movie: *Golden Eye*

Now this is a really cool gadget: a high-res camera that could send pictures directly to MI6 headquarters using a satellite link.

Plausible?

Why not? Many handhelds of today (the O2 XDA II, Treo, and more) have Wi-Fi connectivity. All a camera manufacturer needs to do is put in a Wi-Fi chip to connect to a network. From there on, you can e-mail the image just like you do from a regular cell phone. In fact, the Nikon D2H is already Wi-Fi-enabled!

The only problem might be the size of a high-resolution image. That apart, it would be cool to be able to send pictures to everyone the minute they're clicked! In fact, you could send them to your local digital studio and pick up the prints on your way back home! Now that's the convergence we need to see!

Coolness Quotient: 3.75

Plausibility: 5

Gadget: Ericsson Mobile Phone

Movie: *Tomorrow Never Dies*

Once Q was done with this phone, it was equipped with a stun gun capable of delivering a 2,000 volt electric shock (activated by pressing 'Recall 3'), a finger-

print scanner for breaking into safes, and a mini screwdriver that appeared when the antenna was removed. The phone opened up like a book to reveal a small LCD screen and disc-tapping the disc twice would start the car, and moving the fingers on the disc would drive the car!

Plausible?

Well, apart from the 2,000-volt shocker and the fingerprint scanner, everything else is plausible—the technology of today would certainly let you do it.

As for the 2,000-volt shocker, we wonder what batteries were used! God help Bond if he spilled one of those shaken-but-not-stirred martinis on himself!

It isn't too difficult to incorporate the driving through a cell phone though; most Mercedes cars employ drive-by-wire, wherein everything is computer-dependent and controlled, and whether it receives the instructions from a pedal or from a cell phone is immaterial.

Coolness Quotient: 4.5

Plausibility: 3

Gadget: Aston Martin DB5

Movie: *Tomorrow Never Dies*

Bond has always preferred British cars, and his preferred mode of travel (when not snatching enemy cars or running from them on foot!) is an Aston Martin, in this case, the DB5.

The DB5 featured tyre shredders that could be extended from the wheel hubs; bullet-proof windshields; a retractable bullet shield that rose from inside the boot area; revolving number plates that made the car legal and valid in all countries; a passenger ejector seat for dispensing of unwanted hitchhikers; oil-slick dispensers to get rid of pursuants; smoke screen dispensers; retractable duel machine guns mounted beneath the headlights; rear-mounted duel water cannons for blasting away pursuers; a cellular fax machine, disguised as a car stereo console; a cellular voice-mail system; and let's not forget the refrigerated glove box for storing a bottle of Bollinger and two glasses—after all, Bond never knows when a lady friend might hop in for a spin!

Wouldn't it be cool if our Maruti 800s could have some of this gadgetry? To be fair, the cars of today will let you have a fair bit of the above luxuries—barring the military installations such as machine guns, of course. Let's take a look.

Plausible?

Tyre shredders: Not needed in India, as our government has provided these already; they're called 'roads'!

Bullet-proof windshields: Already a reality in most cars with flashing red lights on top—Dr Manmohan Singh has a reinforced BMW Series 5, which can withstand rocket-launcher attacks!

Revolving number plates: Though illegal, these are far from high-tech.

Most limousines already have cable TV and full communications capabilities. In fact, some outrageously luxurious models even have a mini swimming pool and a helicopter landing pad! For once, Bond was actually *behind* in terms of gadgets.

Coolness Quotient: 4

Plausibility: 4.5